

Tablet App for Mac

User manual · Version 20

macOS 15 or later, Apple silicon · 2026-10-30

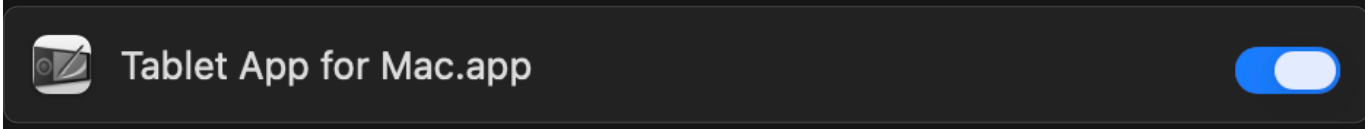
App version 19. British English. Screens are real screenshots from a Mac running earlier versions, so some may differ slightly.

Before you start

Tested only on an Apple silicon Mac with macOS 27.0.1 and a Wacom Intuos4 Small (PTK-440). Other systems and tablets are untested. Use at your own risk.

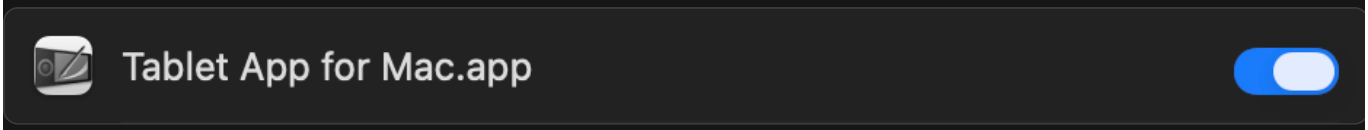
Quick start

- Quit the Wacom driver if it is running (see Wacom driver conflict).
- If the Wacom driver is installed, remove it first with Wacom's own uninstaller (Applications › Wacom Tablet › Wacom Tablet Utility › Tablet Software › Uninstall), then restart your Mac. The app warns you if it still finds it, but never removes it itself.
- Open Tablet App for Mac. A setup window shows two rows, **Read the pen** and **Move the pointer**. Click each button and turn the app on in the list that opens; each row turns green with a tick.
- In System Settings › Privacy & Security › **Input Monitoring**, turn on Tablet App for Mac. This lets the app read the pen.



Input Monitoring, with the switch for Tablet App for Mac turned on

- In System Settings › Privacy & Security › **Accessibility** (called **Device Control and Data Access** on macOS 27), turn on Tablet App for Mac. This lets the pen move the pointer. Quit and reopen the app.



Device Control and Data Access, with the switch for Tablet App for Mac turned on

- If the pen draws in Scribble but the pointer doesn't move, Accessibility is missing. Home shows **Open Device Control and Data Access** (called Accessibility on older macOS).
- On **Home**, check the tablet card shows your tablet as connected.
- Open the tablet, choose **Pen** in the Tool row, and set **Tip Feel**.
- Set **Mapping** to the display you draw on.
- Under **Functions**, set the ExpressKeys and the **Touch ring** modes.
- Click **Save** in the footer. Unsaved changes are kept and offered again after a shutdown.
- Test in **Scribble**.

Introduction and requirements

Tablet App for Mac sets up a pen tablet on macOS: pen feel, buttons, mapping, ExpressKeys and Touch Ring modes, with per-app settings. Tablet input comes from the tablet driver, built on OpenTabletDriver, which the app starts.

- A Mac with Apple silicon.
- macOS 15 or later (the versions .NET 10 supports: 15, 26 and 27).
- The tablet driver, built on OpenTabletDriver (included in the app).
- Input Monitoring and Accessibility permissions (Accessibility is called Device Control and Data Access on macOS 27).
- Uninstall the Wacom driver first, as both can't run at once.

Install and first launch

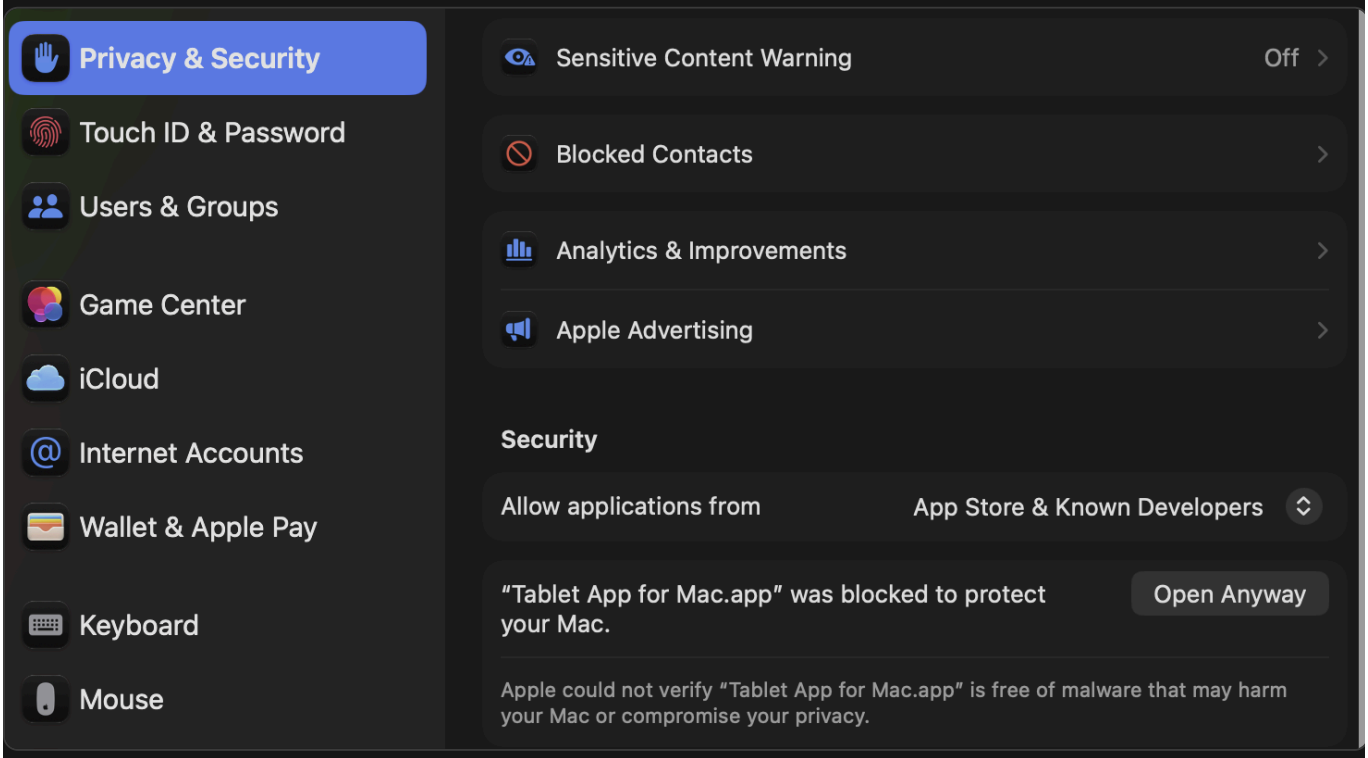
The two permissions (Input Monitoring and Accessibility) are needed only at the first installation. The setup window guides you. From Version 18 on, updates keep them: there is nothing to do.

1. Open **Tablet-App-for-Mac.dmg** and drag **Tablet App for Mac** onto the **Applications** folder. 2. Open the app from Applications. The first time, your Mac may say the app was not opened. Click **Done**. Do not click **Move to Bin**.



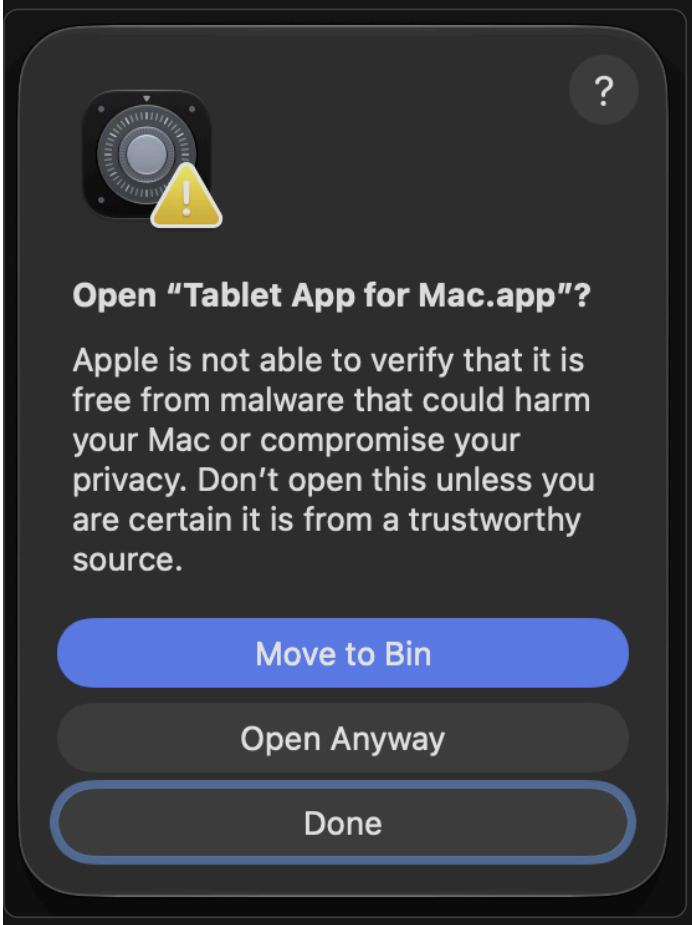
The message "Tablet App for Mac.app Not Opened", with the Done and Move to Bin buttons

3. Open **System Settings › Privacy & Security** and scroll down to **Security**. Next to "Tablet App for Mac.app was blocked to protect your Mac", click **Open Anyway**.



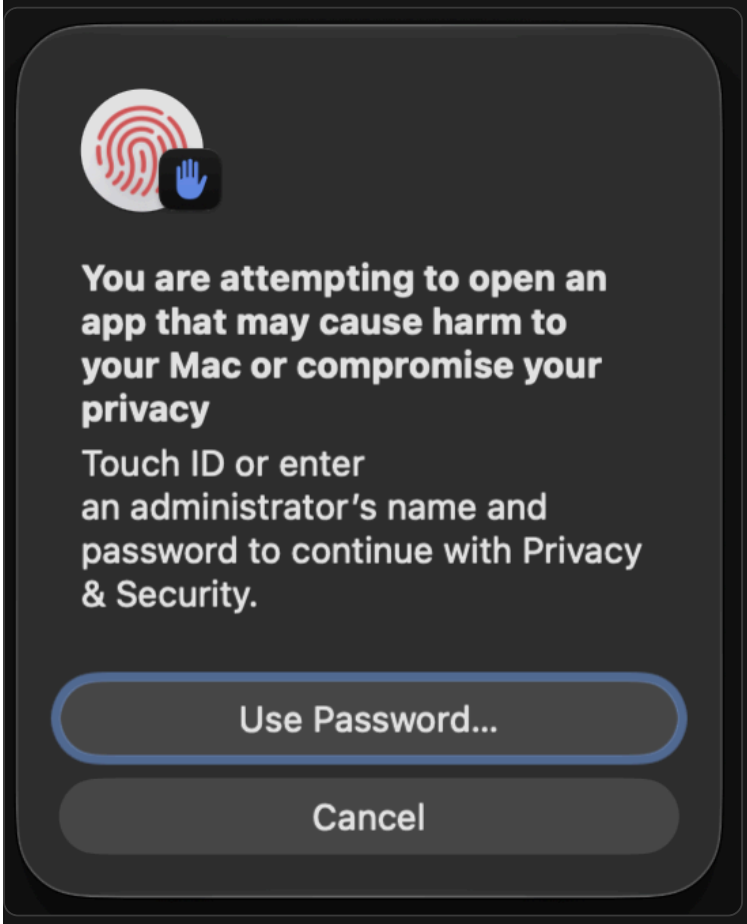
System Settings, Privacy & Security, Security section, with the Open Anyway button next to Tablet App for Mac

4. macOS asks once more. Click **Open Anyway**. Do not click the blue **Move to Bin** button.



The message "Open Tablet App for Mac.app?", with Move to Bin in blue, Open Anyway and Done

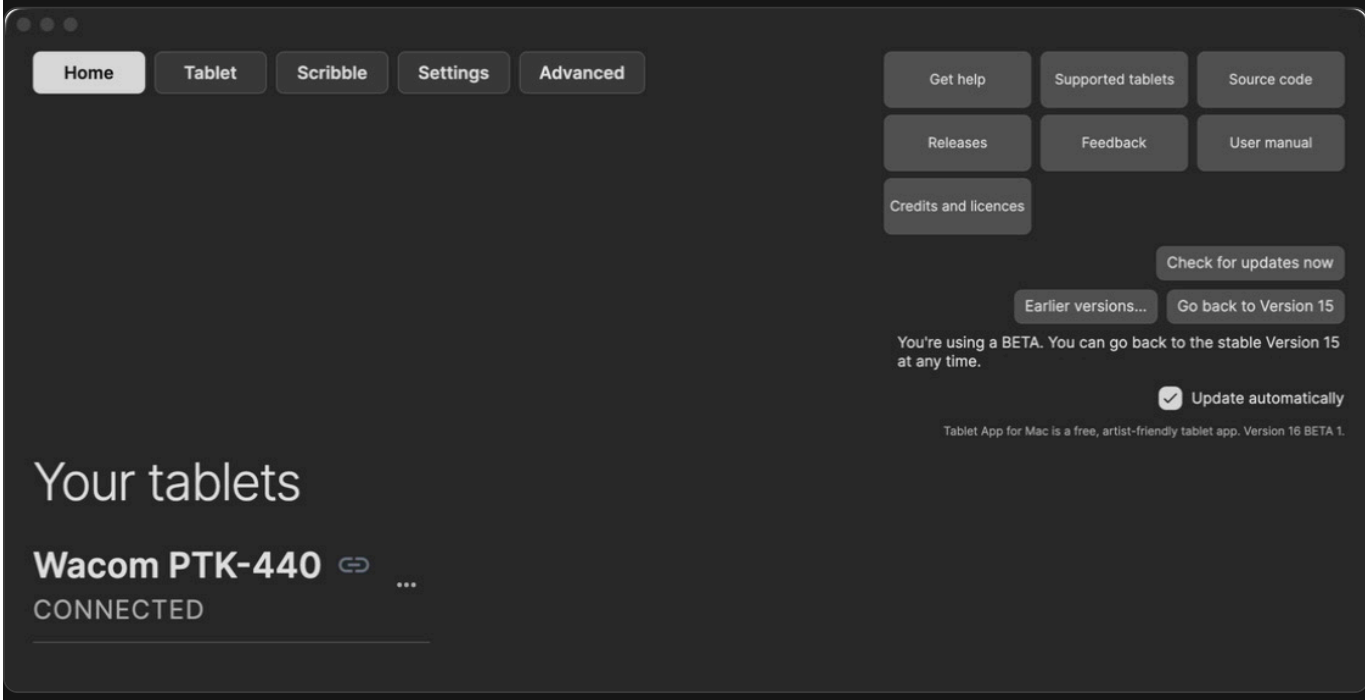
5. Confirm with Touch ID, or click **Use Password…** and enter your Mac login password. The app then opens, and macOS won't ask again.



The Touch ID prompt for Privacy & Security, with Use Password… and Cancel

- macOS asks for **Input Monitoring** (to read the pen) and **Device Control and Data Access** (called **Accessibility** on older macOS; to move the pointer and send keys and clicks). Allow both in System Settings › Privacy & Security, then relaunch the app.
- The app starts its tablet driver. The pen icon stays in the menu bar while it runs.
- To start the app when you log in, switch on **Start automatically when I log in** in **Settings › System** (or add it in System Settings › General › Login Items). At login the app starts silently: only the pen icon in the menu bar shows. Click it to open the window.
- Only one copy runs. Opening the app again brings the running copy to the front.
- To change the language, choose it under **Settings › System › Language**. **Match system** follows your Mac's language.

Home



Home

- **Your tablets**: one card per connected or remembered tablet. Click a card to open its settings.
- Card ⋯ menu: **Open tablet settings**, **Forget this tablet**.
- Health rows: problems found, each with **Fix** or a specific action where one exists. **Fix** works with the pen even while the pen tip or eraser is disabled.
- **Open driver page**: shown when the driver is not reachable.
- **Check for updates now** and **Earlier versions…**: see Updating.

Tablet page layout

- **Device**: the selected tablet. The switcher lists connected and remembered tablets. **+** explains how to add a tablet: connect it to your Mac and it appears in the Device row by itself. **−** forgets the selected tablet and its settings (it asks first).
- **Tool**: **Functions** (ExpressKeys, Touch ring), **Pen** (pen, eraser, mapping), a tile for each extra pen, and **More** (about, calibration, hover, filters, json). **+** explains how to add a pen: bring the new pen close to the tablet and the app adds a tile for it. **−** removes the selected extra pen's settings; the main pen can't be removed.
- **Application**: **All**, or a specific app. **+** adds apps (Command-click to choose several at once). Each added app has its own ExpressKeys, Touch Ring, pen tip and pen button actions. They switch when that app comes to the front, but only once the pen tip is lifted, so a stroke is not interrupted. Mapping and pressure stay the same for every app. **−** removes the selected app's settings; it then uses **All** again.
- **Refresh** reloads the tablet's settings from the driver.
- Footer: **Options…** (Settings), **?** (this manual).

Tablet › Pen



Pen

Control	Default	Function
Tilt › Turn tilt off	Off	Stops sending tilt. Shared with the eraser.
Tip Feel	Middle (linear)	Soft to Firm pressure curve.
Customise…	Closed	Shows the curve, presets **Soft**, **Linear (no curve)**, **Hard**, the input range sliders and **Cut below input minimum (dead zone)** (off).
Current pressure	Live	Pressure after the curve; tooltip shows the raw value.
Button 1 / Button 2 cards	Default (right click) / Default (middle click)	**Change…** opens the function editor; **Default** restores it.
Pen button test	Live	Press a barrel button: its number on the pen picture lights while held, and the line above the cards reads "Button 2 pressed." (or 1).
Movement	Normal (Absolute)	Absolute maps the pen to the screen; Mouse (Relative) moves the cursor like a mouse.
Position smoothing	0.00	Steadies the cursor, with some lag.
Disable pen tip	Off	The tip makes no strokes; the bar reads 0%.
Disable pressure sensitivity	Off	Every stroke uses the Manual Pen Tip Pressure while pressed, in every app.
Manual Pen Tip Pressure	30%	Own frame under Tip Feel. The pressure used while pressure sensitivity is off (0 to 100%).

Extra pens: each pen you use on the tablet gets its own tile in the Tool row, with its own tip, eraser and side-button settings (a copy of the main pen's to start with). Tip Feel, pressure, tilt and mapping are shared by all pens.

Tablet › Eraser



Eraser

The Eraser tab has the same controls as Pen. Separate for the eraser: **Disable eraser** and **Manual Eraser Pressure** (own frame under Eraser Feel; used while pressure sensitivity is off). Shared with Pen (marked "Shared with Pen"): tilt, the Feel curve (one curve for tip and eraser), pressure sensitivity, Movement and Position smoothing. The button cards are the pen's barrel buttons.

Tablet › Mapping



Mapping

Control	Default	Function
Active area	Whole tablet	Drag the area or its corners.
Rotation	0°	180° puts the ExpressKeys on the other side; 90° and 270° are portrait. After rotating, recalibrate (More › calibration) if the pointer no longer sits under the nib.
Display / All displays	Main display	The display the area maps to.
Force proportions	On	Keeps the area at the display's aspect ratio.
Display Settings	–	Opens macOS Displays settings.

Tablet › Functions › ExpressKeys



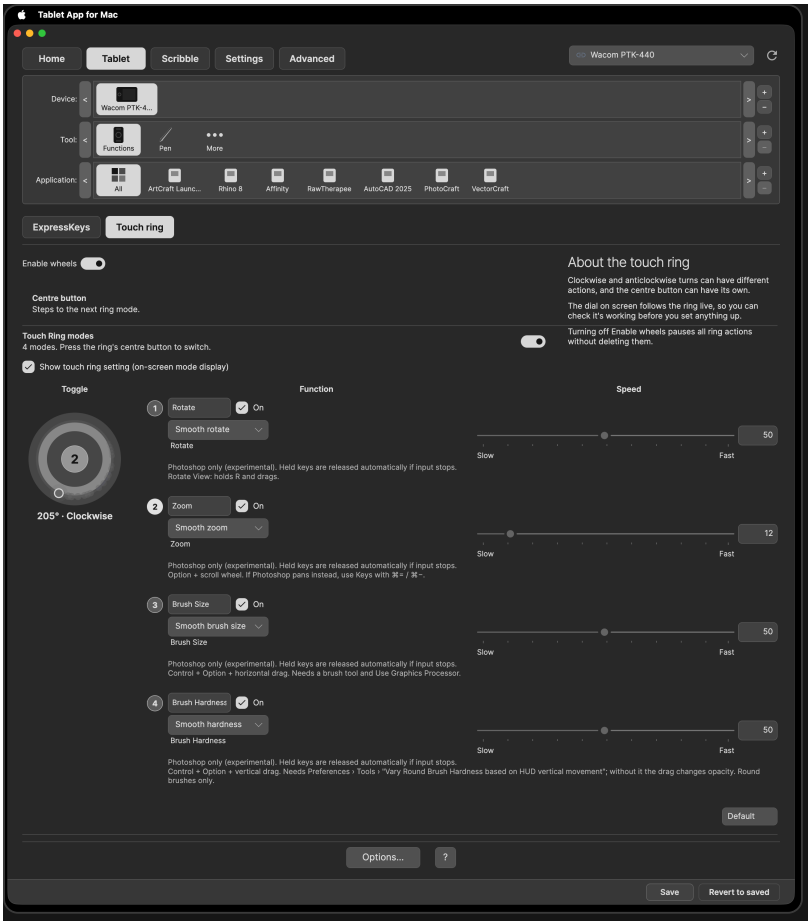
ExpressKeys

- Press a key on the tablet to light its row.
- Row ⋯: **Edit…** opens the function editor, **Clear** removes the action.
- The enable switch turns all ExpressKey actions off or on; actions are kept.
- **Default**: clears every ExpressKey action, after asking.

Function editor: **Keyboard** (a shortcut; Cmd, Ctrl, Shift and Option are held modifiers), **Mouse** (Left, Right, Middle click, Back and Forward button), **Scroll** (up, down, left, right, or **Move pen to scroll**: hold the button and move the pen to scroll like a mouse wheel; the cursor stays still and the tip does not click), **Media** (Mute, Volume down, Volume up, Play / Pause, Previous track, Next track, Stop). **Save**, **Cancel**, **Clear**.

Tablet › Functions › Touch ring

- **Enable wheels**: On. Pauses all ring actions without deleting them.
- **Touch Ring modes**: On. "4 modes. Press the ring's centre button to switch."
- **Show touch ring setting (on-screen mode display)**: On. Shows the mode name when you switch.
- The dial follows the ring live: the dot sits under your finger. The angle and turn direction show under the ring, for example "0° · Clockwise". 12 o'clock is 0° and 3 o'clock is 90°.
- The active mode is highlighted; its number is lit, centred, and also shows on the centre button.



Touch ring in use

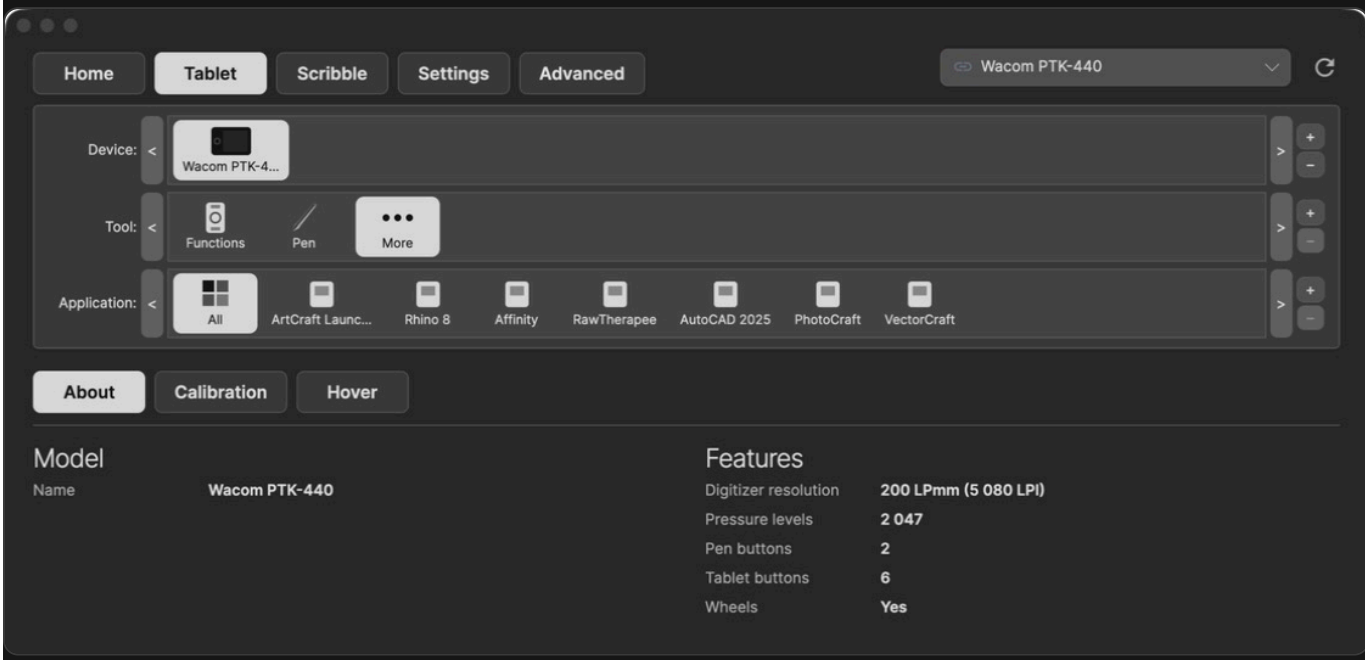
- On-screen centre button: moves the highlight to the next mode so you can edit it; it doesn't change the mode the tablet uses. Only the tablet's own centre button switches the mode.
- Per mode: name, **On**, **Function** (Keystroke…, or the experimental smooth actions), **Speed** (Slow to Fast, slider or typed), and the **Clockwise** and **Anticlockwise** keys.
- **Speed**, the same scale for every function: 1 acts once every 180° of ring, 50 about every 30°, 100 on every ring step. For **Smooth rotate**, **Smooth brush size** and **Smooth hardness** in Photoshop, the Speed sets how far the canvas turns or the brush changes.
- Where the smooth actions work: **Smooth rotate**, **Smooth brush size** and **Smooth hardness** in Photoshop; **Smooth zoom** (Option + scroll wheel) in Photoshop and Affinity; **Smooth rotate** in Affinity uses ⌘ + scroll wheel, so first turn on **Enable canvas rotation with ⌘+scroll wheel** in Affinity's **Settings › Tools**. In any other app, a smooth mode sends its **Clockwise** and **Anticlockwise** keys at its Speed. If Photoshop moves the canvas up and down instead of zooming, untick **Zoom with Scroll Wheel** in Photoshop's **Settings › Tools**, or use **Keystroke** with ⌘= / ⌘−.
- With an app selected in the **Application** row, the ring settings you change are that app's. Select **All** to change them for every other app.
- Coming from Version 16 BETA 1 or earlier: the ring modes ran backwards there (a clockwise turn zoomed out). The app turns them the right way round when it opens; click **Save** once to keep it.
- **Default** restores the four modes:

Mode	Clockwise	Anticlockwise	Every
Rotate	Option+F13	Option+F14	10°
Zoom	Cmd+=	Cmd+−	30°
Brush size	]	[	8°
Brush hardness	Shift+]	Shift+[	60°

Touch strips (Intuos3, Cintiq 21UX, Cintiq 12WX and Cintiq 22HD; new in Version 16, not yet tested on these tablets): the page shows each strip, **Touch strip** or **Left touch strip** and **Right touch strip**, with an **Up** and a **Down** row instead of the ring. Slide your finger up or down the strip to send that row's keys. Strips have no centre button, so they have no ring modes.

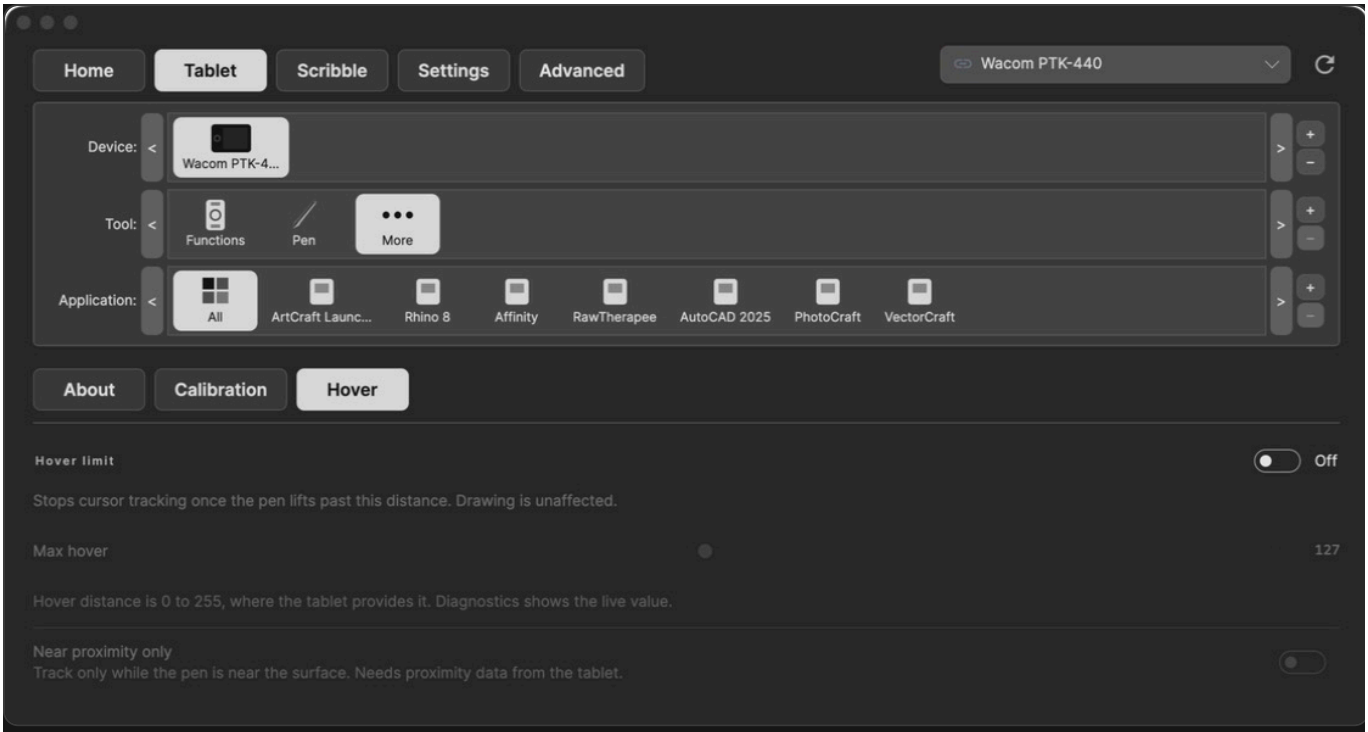
Tablet › More

- **about**: the tablet's model and features: digitiser resolution, pressure levels, pen buttons, **Tablet buttons** and wheels.



More › About

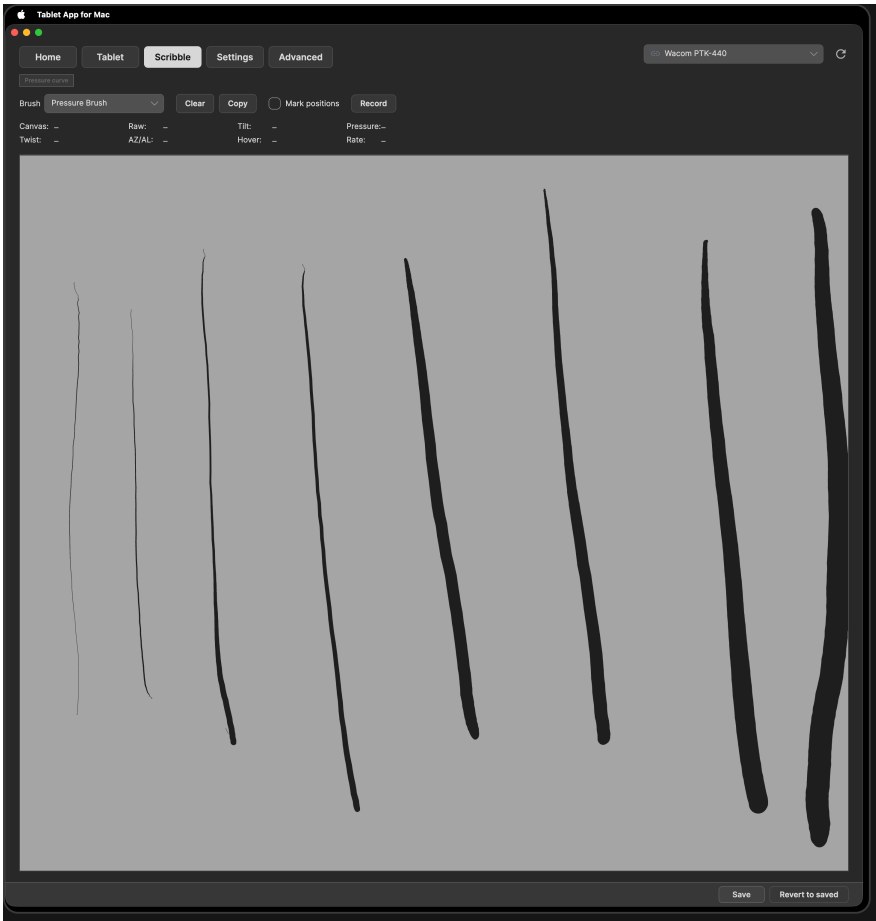
- **calibration**: **Start** shows full-screen targets; tap each, then **Apply**. **More calibration actions**: **View report…**, **Export calibration…**, **Import calibration…**, **Clear calibration**. The on/off switch turns the calibration correction off and on, so you can compare. Calibrate only if the pointer sits away from the nib.
- **hover** (below): hover limit, off by default; 127 when first switched on (0 to 255). The pen stops moving the cursor when it is higher above the tablet than this limit.
- **filters**: the OpenTabletDriver filters on this tablet.
- **json**: the profile as the driver stores it.



More › Hover

Scribble

A test canvas with a precise crosshair cursor. If the canvas says "Drawing is off because the pen isn't set to follow the screen", click **Use pen on screen**: Movement becomes **Normal (Absolute)** and, if needed, the pen is mapped to all displays. The same settings are in **Tablet › Pen › Movement** and **Tablet › Mapping**. Draws with the processed pressure, so the curve, Disable pen tip and the Manual Pressure are visible.



Scribble

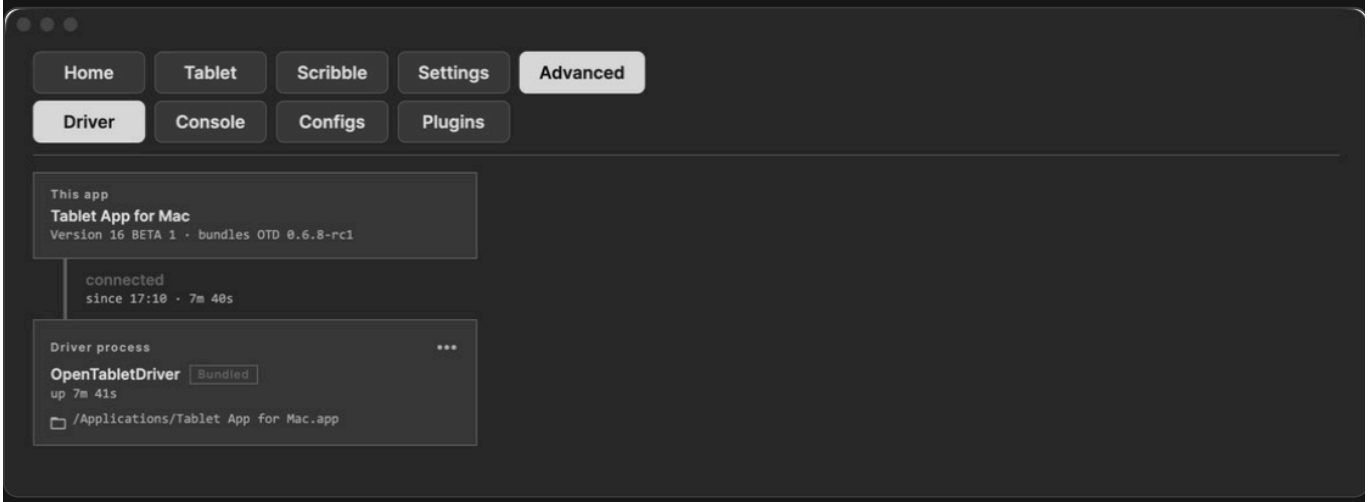
Mark positions draws a dot for each position the tablet reports. **Clear**, **Copy**. **Record** and **Stop** save a stroke recording.

Settings

- **Theme**: **Themes** (Graphite, Silver, Charcoal, Rose, Burgundy, Custom, System; default Graphite), brightness, **Backdrops** (Solid colour, Generated gradient, **Add glow**, **Choose image…**), **Colours** (Highlight colour, Card colour). **Reset to defaults**.
- **Hotkeys**: global shortcuts for tablet actions and **Load a preset**. **Assign…**, **Clear**. Default: not set.
- **Presets**: see Presets and saving.
- **System › Status light** (Intuos4 only): **Light up the status light when the pen touches** is on by default. The tablet's status light stays dim and gets bright while the pen touches, as it did with the Wacom driver. Switch it off for one steady brightness. The setting is sent to the tablet once when it connects, not while you draw.
- **System › Settings backup**: **Export settings…** saves all your settings in one file: tablets, pens and per-pen settings, presets, applications, Touch Ring modes, calibration and app settings. The suggested name is the tablet model and the date, for example `Intuos4PTK440_30Oct26.tabletsettings` (`TabletApp_30Oct26` when no tablet is connected); you can type another name. Serial numbers and your user name are left out, so you can email the file to someone else or keep it for a new Mac. **Import settings…** opens a file and lists what would change (**New**, **Changed**, **Same**) before anything happens; click **Apply these settings** or **Cancel**. Your current settings are backed up first. Then quit and reopen the app.

- **Settings files in Finder**: a `.tabletsettings` file shows the app icon on a page. Double-click it to open Tablet App for Mac at **Settings › System** with its Import preview; nothing changes until you click **Apply these settings**.
- **App menu**: the **Tablet App for Mac** menu at the top left of the screen has **About Tablet App for Mac** (opens Home, with the version and links), **Export settings…** and **Import settings…** (the same as the buttons in Settings › System; results show in the main window). The pen menu in the menu bar has them too.
- **System › Automatic backups**: when a new version starts for the first time, the app backs up all your settings by itself, and it does the same before every import. The last 5 are kept. **Preview…** shows what bringing one back would change; **Show in Finder** opens the folder.
- **System › Diagnostic file**: **Create diagnostic file** saves one zip on your Desktop with a summary (app, driver and macOS versions, connected tablets, other tablet drivers found), the app and driver logs and your settings. Serial numbers and your user name are removed. The path shows under the button; attach the zip to a GitHub issue. The same button is on **Advanced › Diagnostics**.
- **System**: **Start at login**. Switch on **Start automatically when I log in** to have the app start by itself when you log in to your Mac, with only the pen icon in the menu bar. **Open Login Items…** opens the same setting in macOS: System Settings › General › Login Items.

Advanced



Advanced › Driver

- **Driver**: the **Driver process** card, with **Start**, **Restart** and **Stop** in its ⋯ menu; **Open OpenTabletDriver's own window**; **Open the folder holding this driver**.
- **Plugins**: **Rescan plugin folder**, **Open plugin folder**.
- **Configs** (tablet configs): **Check for more configs**, **Install**, **View**.
- **Console**: severity filter, text filter, **Auto-scroll** (on), copy as text, Markdown or HTML, **Clear**.
- **Diagnostics** (shown when **Settings › Dev** turns it on): **Start** and **Stop** live reports, and **Create diagnostic file**.

About and Options

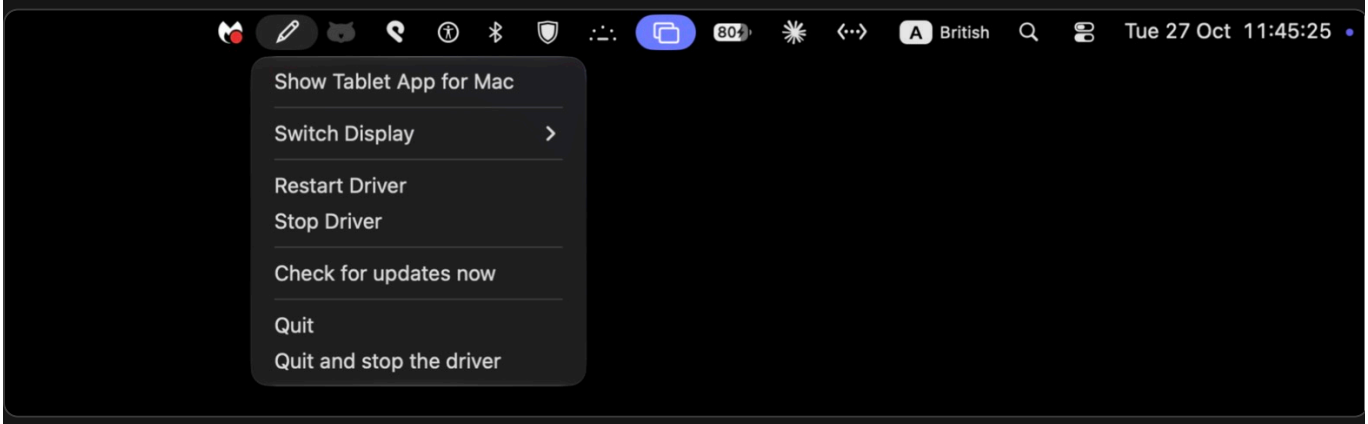
About shows the version and links: **Get help** (this manual), **Supported tablets**, **Source code**, **Releases**, **User manual**, **Credits and licences**, **Feedback**. **Options…** opens Settings.

Presets and saving

- Changes apply at once; the footer shows **Save** and **Revert to saved** while there are unsaved changes.
- **Save** writes the settings. **Revert to saved** goes back to the last save.
- After a shutdown or crash with unsaved changes, the app offers the snapshot again at the next launch.
- **Save as preset** stores the whole configuration under a name. Preset ⋯: **Update from current settings**, **Duplicate**, **Rename…**, **Delete**. **Load** applies it.

The pen menu

The pen icon in the menu bar at the top of the screen shows that Tablet App for Mac is running. Click it to open its menu.



The pen icon in the menu bar with its menu open

The **driver** is the background part of the app that reads the pen and moves the pointer. It keeps working while the window is closed.

- **Show Tablet App for Mac** opens the app's window.
- **Switch Display** chooses which screen the tablet draws on, when you have more than one screen.
- **Restart Driver** stops the background part and starts it again. Try this first if the pen stops responding.
- **Stop Driver** stops the background part, so the pen stops working until you start it again. While it is stopped, the menu shows **Start Driver** instead.
- **Check for updates now** checks for a new version (see Updating).
- **Export settings…** and **Import settings…** open the app at Settings › System and do the same as the buttons there.
- **Quit** closes the app and removes the pen icon. The background part keeps running, so the pen still works with the settings you saved.
- **Quit and stop the driver** closes the app and stops the background part too, so the pen stops working until you open the app again.

Quitting

- **Cmd+Q** quits the app straight away, without asking. Unsaved changes are kept and offered at the next launch. If the app started the driver, the driver stops too, so the pen stops working until you open the app again.

- To close only the window, click its red close button. The app stays in the menu bar and the tablet keeps working.
- **Quit** in the pen menu closes the app; **Quit and stop the driver** also stops the pen (see The pen menu). With unsaved changes it asks "Save changes before quitting?": **Cancel** keeps the app open, **Don't Save** quits without saving, **Save** saves and quits.
- Quitting also happens at shutdown and logout; unsaved changes are then kept and offered at the next launch.

Tested system and tablet

macOS 27.0.1 on Apple silicon, Wacom Intuos4 Small (PTK-440). Nothing else has been tested.

Supported tablets

Supported tablets (in **About**) lists every tablet the driver knows, with its support level (**Supported**, **Has Quirks**, **Questionable** or **Missing Features**) and notes. The Wacom tablets are also listed on the website: https://digitalgroceries.github.io/tablet-app-for-mac/tablets/

Version 16 adds the following. None of it has been tested on these tablets yet, so please tell us how it works (**Feedback** on **Home**):

- Intuos Pro (PTH-460, PTH-660, PTH-860): the Touch Ring turns the right way and its zero is at the left, like other Wacom rings.
- Intuos3 (PTZ-430, PTZ-431W, PTZ-630, PTZ-631W, PTZ-930, PTZ-1230, PTZ-1231W), Cintiq 21UX (DTZ-2100 and DTK-2100), Cintiq 12WX (DTZ-1200W) and Cintiq 22HD (DTK-2200, DTH-2200): touch strips (see Touch ring).
- Cintiq 13HD (DTK-1300, DTH-1300): the centre button of the Rocker Ring, as ExpressKey 9.
- Bamboo Fun (CTE-450, CTE-650): the Touch Ring.
- Wacom CTK-4120: newly listed.

Version 19 adds: Cintiq 21UX (DTK-2100) and Cintiq 22HD (DTK-2200, DTH-2200): the ExpressKeys are read the way the Linux Wacom driver reads them, so each key sends its own setting. If you set up these keys in an earlier version, check them once on **Tablet › Functions › ExpressKeys**; the app shows a note in the main window. Not yet tested on these tablets.

Wacom driver conflict

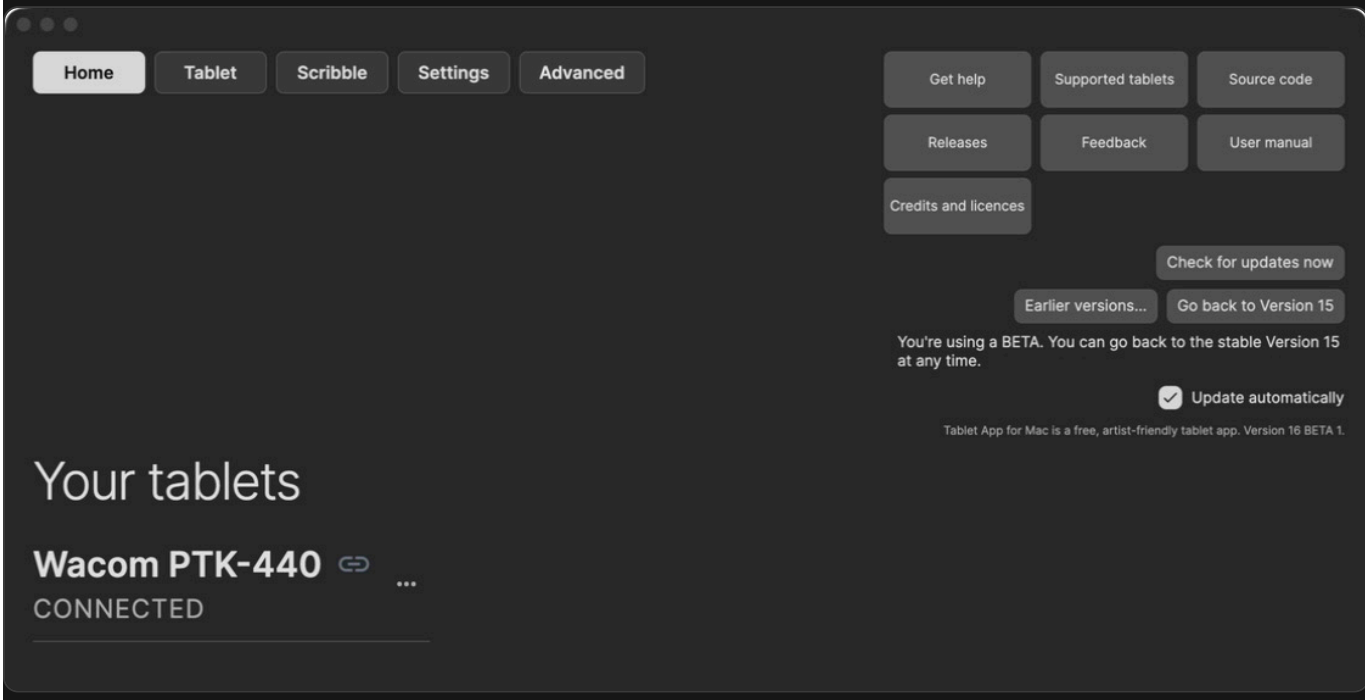
The Wacom driver and OpenTabletDriver cannot both use the tablet. Quit or uninstall the Wacom driver before using this app. Home shows a warning while it is running. The app also checks which programs are running every 15 seconds and shows **Another tablet driver is running** on **Home** when it finds the Wacom driver (WacomTabletDriver, TabletDriver, Wacom_IOManager, WacomTabletSpringboard, DataStoreMgr), the Xencelabs driver, or a second OpenTabletDriver daemon.

Updating

Version 19: messages and dialogs now open inside the main window, not as separate windows.

Permissions: from Version 18 on, updates keep both permissions; there is nothing to do. **Updating from Version 17 or older:** once, in System Settings › Privacy & Security › **Input Monitoring** and **Device Control and Data Access** (called **Accessibility** on older macOS), remove the old Tablet App for Mac entries with **–**, add the app with **+** and switch it on.

- The app checks for updates once a week when it starts. When there is a new stable version, it asks **Update now?** Click **Update now** and the app downloads it, checks it, installs it and opens again by itself.
- To check any time, click **Check for updates now** on **Home** (top right, under the About links). When there is a choice, Home shows **Install Version N** (the newest stable version) and **Try Version N BETA M** (a BETA: new features, not tested yet). While you use a BETA, **Go back to Version N** returns you to the stable version.
- **Update automatically** is an optional setting just below it. It is off unless you turn it on. When it is on, the app downloads a new stable version by itself, then asks for OK before installing. It never installs a BETA by itself.
- To go back to an earlier version, click **Earlier versions…** on **Home** and choose one of the two most recent stable versions older than the one you have. This works from a stable version and from a BETA. Your settings stay.



Home while using a BETA, with Check for updates now, Earlier versions…, Go back to Version 15, and the Update automatically setting

- The two permissions are asked for only at the first installation. Updates from Version 18 on keep them.
- **Coming from Version 6:** install Version 7 or later by hand once (see Install and first launch). Then do the one-time step for Version 17 or older above.
- **Permission switches turn themselves off?** macOS is still holding the entries of Version 17 or older. Make sure the app is in **Applications** (not opened from the disk image or Downloads). On **Home**, click **Reset permissions**. Then in System Settings › Privacy & Security › **Input Monitoring** and **Device Control and Data Access** (called **Accessibility** on older macOS): select every old Tablet App for Mac entry and remove it with **–**, then click **+**, add Tablet App for Mac from Applications, switch it on, and restart the app. In Terminal the same reset is `tccutil reset ListenEvent com.freetabletapp.mac` and `tccutil reset Accessibility com.freetabletapp.mac`.
- **By hand, if you prefer:** quit the app, replace it in Applications with the new version, and open it.

Going back to an earlier build

Click **Earlier versions…** on **Home** (Version 15 and later), or download an earlier build from Releases and replace the app. Settings are kept. Going back to Version 17 or older needs the one-time − then + step under Updating.

Uninstalling

- Quit from the menu bar.
- Delete the app from Applications.
- Remove its entries from **Input Monitoring** and **Accessibility** (on macOS 27: **Device Control and Data Access**) with **−**.
- Remove its Login Item if you added one (System Settings › General › Login Items).
- Optional: delete its settings folder, ~/Library/Application Support/Tablet App for Mac.

Credits and licences

Tablet App for Mac is a modified version of OpenTabletArtist by TheSevenPens (GPL-3.0) and uses OpenTabletDriver (LGPL-3.0). The full list of packages and licence texts is on the Credits and licences page. Some features (settings backup, the diagnostic file and the running-driver check) use ideas from MockTab by Cyzor (GPL-3).

Glossary

- **Tip Feel**: the pressure curve, from Soft to Firm.
- **Touch Ring modes**: up to four sets of ring actions, switched with the centre button.
- **Touch strip**: the finger strip on Intuos3 and older Cintiqs. It works like the ring, with Up and Down.
- **Preset**: a named copy of the whole configuration.
- **Application row**: per-app settings; **All** applies everywhere else.
- **Shared with Pen**: an Eraser setting that is the same setting as on the Pen tab.
- **Driver**: the background part of the app that reads the pen and moves the pointer, built on OpenTabletDriver.
- **BETA**: a new version that is not tested yet. You can go back to the stable version at any time.

Not written here

Troubleshooting and the per-app notes (Photoshop, Affinity, PhotoCraft) are written separately. Per-app shortcuts: not yet tested.